Daily reports · 29 October 2026

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Syria Narrative Tracker · as of the last update, 29 October 2026, 19:23 UTC

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1. The day at a glance

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Frustrated Flash floods dominate the news cycle, killing several people, destroying bridges and roads, and flooding camps in the east and north, with state media stressing rescue efforts while public comments mock poor drainage and neglected infrastructure. Anger continues over Jordanian airstrikes on Daraa, with officials visiting victims' families while many commenters demand an apology and accountability from Amman. Iraqi PM al-Zaidi's Damascus visit and shrine donation draws largely positive reaction, Israeli incursions in Quneitra persist with little outrage, and Kurdish-language posts express distrust over SDF disarmament and Afrin property seizures.

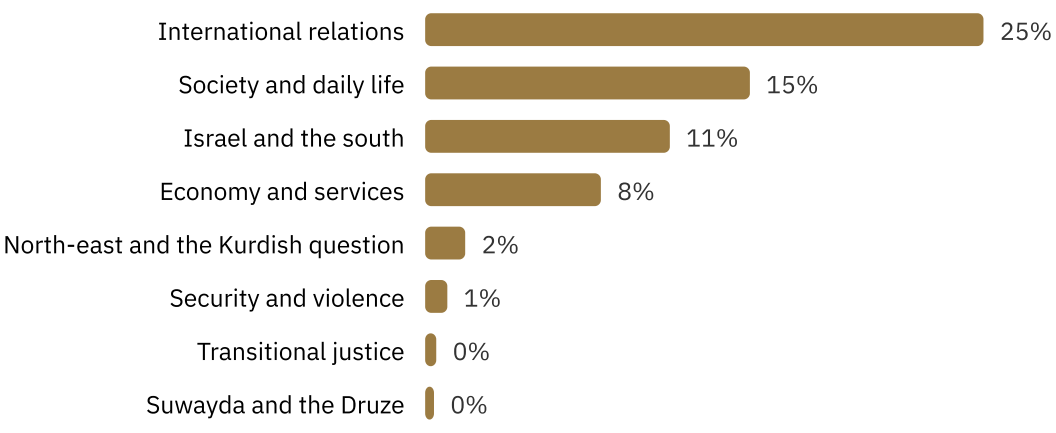
2. What people said

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The day in numbers

Mostly neutral	Mostly neutral	13	3,245	4
People's tone	Outlets' tone	stories followed	post analyses	updates

Share of discussion by theme



The day's stories

1. **Iraqi PM al-Zaidi's historic Damascus visit and $10M shrine donation** International relations · People: strongly positive · Outlets: leaning positive · 31% of the discussion
   Iraqi PM Ali al-Zaidi visited Damascus, meeting President al-Sharaa to discuss oil exports via the Baniyas pipeline, trade and security cooperation. He personally donated $10 million to restore the Umayyad Mosque and Sayyida Zainab shrine, a gesture widely covered as historic and symbolically significant for Iraq-Syria ties since Assad's fall.

2. **Flash floods kill several and disrupt life across eastern and northern Syria** Economy and services · People: leaning negative · Outlets: mostly neutral · 27% of the discussion
   Heavy rains and flash floods hit Raqqa, Deir ez-Zor, Aleppo, Hasakah and Homs provinces on 29 October, killing five people including four children and leaving five missing, according to Syria's Ministry of Emergency and Disaster Management. Bridges collapsed, roads were cut, IDP camps flooded, and civil defense teams rescued dozens. Officials say 165 field responses were carried out across six provinces.

3. **Fallout from Jordanian airstrikes on Daraa continues** Israel and the south · People: strongly negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 14% of the discussion
   Jordanian airstrikes on northern Daraa countryside killed several civilians including children; Syria summoned Jordan's ambassador and formed a joint security committee with Jordan to investigate. Foreign Minister Asaad al-Shaibani toured Daraa, offered condolences, and vowed accountability, while many Syrians online express anger at perceived government inaction and demand a formal Jordanian apology.

4. **Shop closures and layoffs spark debate over Damascus and Aleppo market stagnation** Economy and services · People: strongly negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 4% of the discussion
   Reports on shop closures and worker layoffs in Damascus and Aleppo markets drew heavy public commentary blaming high rents, Turkish and Chinese import competition, corruption and poor governance. Commenters compared current hardship unfavorably to, and in some cases nostalgically with, the Assad era.

5. **Kurdish officials say armed groups block displaced Afrin residents' return and seize property** North-east and the Kurdish question · People: strongly negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 3% of the discussion
   Kurdish politician Ilham Ahmed said armed groups in Afrin remain the main obstacle to the return of displaced residents, citing seizure of homes, farmland and olive harvests, and illegal taxes. She called on the Syrian government to protect civilians and return seized property to its owners.

6. **Israeli incursions and shelling continue in Quneitra** Israel and the south · People: leaning negative · Outlets: leaning negative · 3% of the discussion
   Israeli forces conducted ground incursions, set up checkpoints, detained a man, and fired artillery shells near Saida al-Golan in southern Quneitra, with UNDOF inspecting the site. Outlets reported 14 incursions, seven detentions and three shelling incidents in Quneitra and Daraa between 12-19 October alone, as the Arab Group at the UN condemned ongoing violations.

7. **Transitional justice: life sentences, mass grave remains, and new recovery center** Transitional justice · People: leaning positive · Outlets: mostly neutral · 2% of the discussion
   Syrian courts sentenced former Liwa al-Quds/IRGC-linked militiaman Abdul Jabbar Ghazi Arziq to life in prison, while remains believed to belong to victims of a 2012 massacre were found in Homs. Separately, the National Commission for Transitional Justice opened its first recovery center for victims of abuses, in Homs, with international support.

8. **Backlash over decision affecting Rojava and Kobani universities' status** North-east and the Kurdish question · People: leaning negative · Outlets: mostly neutral · 2% of the discussion
   Syria agreed on final steps to integrate Kobani and Rojava Universities into the structures of Euphrates and Aleppo universities, sparking objections from Kurdish academics who call it comparable to the former regime's 'Arab Belt' policy. A Rojava University professor said the move threatens recognition of Kurdish-language education.

9. **Idlib clashes with 'French Camp' fighters continue amid security tensions** Security and violence · Outlets: leaning negative · 1% of the discussion
   Tensions persist in Idlib between Syrian security forces and foreign fighters known locally as the 'French camp,' following earlier clashes and the death of a French fighter. Enab Baladi reported an armed man killed and a civilian wounded, while separate posts mention two Syrian soldiers killed in an armed attack in Idlib's countryside.

10. **Armed Druze faction again blocks Suwayda officials from reaching offices** Suwayda and the Druze · Outlets: leaning negative · 1% of the discussion
    An armed group outside state control blocked Suwayda governorate employees at the Umm al-Zaytoun checkpoint from reaching the general secretariat office, marking the third such blockade in recent days. Officials say this disrupts government work and basic services for residents.

11. **Confusion over reports of a new German travel warning for Syria** International relations · Outlets: mostly neutral · 1% of the discussion
    Conflicting reports circulated about whether Germany issued a new travel warning for Syria; the German embassy in Damascus told Syria TV no new warning was issued, only reaffirming existing guidance amid regional security concerns, while Reuters published and then withdrew a report claiming a new warning.

12. **Concerns over gender representation in revised school curricula** Society and daily life · Outlets: leaning negative · 0% of the discussion
    The fact-checking platform Ta'akad documented deletions of images of women and girls, added hijabs to illustrations, and removed lessons on citizenship and political participation in new Syrian textbooks compared to older editions. Women's rights groups like Femina called on the Education Ministry to reverse the changes.

13. **Details emerge on killing of driver Qais Sanufa near Damascus** Security and violence · Outlets: mostly neutral · 0% of the discussion
    Syria's Interior Ministry security directorate in Qudsaya, rural Damascus, disclosed circumstances of the killing of Qais Sanufa. Separately, internal security forces arrested two people after a traffic stop confrontation in Qudsaya's al-Wurud neighborhood that led to their car striking three children while fleeing.

3. Sources and method

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